

daily morning brief on AI announcements, a weekly digest of long reads on a specific topic. Structure it as role + task + output format + cadence for reliable results.

This is especially useful because rather than manually re-prompting the same research request every morning, you set it once and it arrives on schedule. For any workflow that depends on staying current, this converts a recurring manual chore into a standing feed.

Connect your data via Apps/Connectors

Data connections – formerly "Connectors," now being folded into "Apps" – link Google Drive, SharePoint, email, and CRM so file search and deep research reach into your own documents. This is nothing short of a superpower, because ChatGPT can now ground answers in your actual archive – past articles, academic syllabus, briefing docs – without you uploading anything per-chat, and without building any retrieval pipeline or vector database yourself. Research that used to mean hunting through Drive and pasting excerpts becomes a single query that spans your own corpus alongside the web.

Audit what shaped a reply

The new "sources" view (tap the book icon below a response) shows which past chats, files, custom instructions, connected Gmail, and memories influenced that specific answer – and lets you edit or erase any of them right there. This is a great insight into how ChatGPT answers your queries, which you can personalize and take control of, if needed.

Because earlier, personalization used to be a black box, so when ChatGPT brought up something oddly specific you couldn't tell why. Now you can trace a reply back to its inputs and correct the offending memory or source on the spot – which matters when accuracy and knowing your sources is part of the job.

DID YOU KNOW?

ChatGPT's great at building a **working, interactive app from a single conversation**. Using Canvas plus its code-execution and file-handling, describe a tool you wish existed – say, a personalized spaced-repetition flashcard app that schedules your reviews and tracks your streak – and walk out of one chat with a functioning, shareable thing, not just code you have to assemble yourself.

Google Gemini

Build Gems (custom assistants)

Open the sidebar → Gems → New Gem. Give it a name, write persistent instructions (the system prompt – what it does, what tone and format to use, what to prioritise), optionally pick a default tool like Deep Research or Create Image, and attach knowledge sources: uploaded files, Google Drive docs, even connected NotebookLM notebooks. The key distinction from custom instructions – which apply to every chat – is that a Gem only activates when you open it.

For example, instead of re-pasting your essay rubric, your professor's citation style, or your CV and the job

description at the start of every chat, you bake them in once and the Gem remembers. A student can build a "Thermodynamics Tutor" loaded with the actual course PDF so explanations match the syllabus rather than a generic textbook; a young professional can keep a "Cover Letter Writer" that already knows their background and writing voice. Building Gems is free on every plan, so the only reason not to make one is if a task is truly one-off.

Gemini ships with ready-made Gems – Brainstormer, Learning coach, Writing editor, Coding partner, and a Productivity-planner type Gem that can pull from Gmail, Calendar, and Drive – sitting in the left panel. Most are customisable: if one's close but not quite right, make a copy (like duplicating a Doc, no pasting needed) and edit its instructions. Check these before building from scratch; for a lot of study and writing tasks, the premade one plus a small edit is all you need.

Set time-bound actions to unlock new powers

On Google AI Pro or Ultra (and qualifying Workspace education/business plans), you can set recurring prompts that run automatically in the background – a morning briefing of your calendar and unread emails, a weekly digest, a daily scan of news in your field

